Chirag Dilli, Delhi

Two deadlines: people sleeping rough die of cold from now to March, and the deadliest heat comes in April–June 2027, after the El Niño winter. Use the winter to get both ready.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
NCT of Delhi (state level, ~20 million people)	300 forecast (340 incl. Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Heat (Apr–Jun 2027); cold and smog now

18/18 recommendations verified. 15 corrected, 0 unverified, 4 contraindicated (the four "Do not do this" cards). One funding placement (HelpAge India) is unverified and is left out of the target. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for the whole of NCT of Delhi, not for Chirag Dilli, and it counts heat only. The funding target fell from the panel's ₹7.75 lakh to ₹5.75 lakh after verification (−26%): cool roofs were costed as lime wash when the delivery partner uses reflective paint, and Delhi's own trial found about 1 °C of cooling, so the roof line was cut to 200 roofs.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



28.54°N 77.23°E, India · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Delhi's homeless die of exposure every winter, and its record heat came in the summers after the 1997, 2009, and 2023 El Niños.
- **For you.** From 15 November, call 14461 whenever you see someone sleeping in the open on a cold night. It costs nothing.
- **The money.** ₹1.75 lakh / ₹5.75 lakh / ₹25.5 lakh (US$1,840 / 6,040 / 26,770); night outreach and blankets buy the most lives.
- **Do not.** Do not send people to a cooling centre or night shelter nobody has checked: in 2026 audits, three of seven centres were shut by 8 pm and about half of shelter fans and coolers did not work.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT 5 STEPS

In Chirag Dilli, El Niño shows up as rising food prices this winter and as dangerous heat in the top-floor rooms of the old havelis next spring, when water is shortest. The ranked actions below are written for the city and its partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

Call 14461 whenever you see someone sleeping in the open on a cold night, 15 November to 15 March

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Every cold night, 15 Nov 2026 – 15 Mar 2027	None	People sleeping rough near the dargah and the Outer Ring Road

14461 is the short code the Department of Telecommunications allocated to Delhi's night-shelter control room. DUSIB's rescue teams take people to a shelter or winter tent, where bedding is already provided. The tents usually go up on 15 November; the 2026–27 plan had not been published at the time of writing.

If anyone at home is 70 or older, get them a Vay Vandana card before March

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED RESIDENT-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
31 Mar 2027	None	Hospital costs for older people in a heat or smog emergency

It covers hospital treatment up to ₹5 lakh from the national scheme plus ₹5 lakh from Delhi (₹10 lakh, about US$10,500), with no income test for people aged 70 and over. Bring Aadhaar to a ration-centre enrolment drive, or use the Ayushman app. Only about 2.9 lakh Delhi residents had one by May 2026.

If your household earns under ₹1.2 lakh a year, apply for a ration card online now, while places are open

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Before 31 Jan 2027	None	Free monthly grain when prices peak in spring

Delhi reopened applications on 15 May 2026, the first time in 13 years, after an audit freed about 7.7 lakh places. Apply at edistrict.delhigovt.nic.in. The Cabinet approved raising the income limit to ₹2.5 lakh on 26 May 2026, but no notification of that was found, so households between ₹1.2 and ₹2.5 lakh should apply and check.

If you live on the top floor, lime-wash or paint your roof white before April

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 9

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
31 Mar 2027	About ₹400–800 (US$4–8) for an 80 sq ft room in lime wash; ₹2,000–3,200 (US$21–34) in reflective paint	Comfort and sleep in the hottest rooms

Expect a room about 1–3 °C cooler, not more: Delhi's own trial of reflective paint found about 1 °C, and a Bakkarwala house measured 2–3 °C. Lime wash washes off in the monsoon and needs redoing each year. It makes a room more bearable; it is not a substitute for getting someone out of the heat.

Buy onions from the government vans at ₹35/kg, and use the Sheikh Sarai Atal Canteen for ₹5 meals

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Now, while onion prices are high	₹35/kg onion; ₹5 a meal	The household food budget

Onion prices were up 108% on a year in September. NAFED, NCCF, and Kendriya Bhandar vans sell at ₹35/kg in Delhi. The nearest Atal Canteen is on Apeejay School Road in Sheikh Sarai, about 1–2 km away; canteens have run out of food at busy times, so go early.

What to ask of the people in charge

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- Ask your ward councillor (Ward 172) to press the Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers Welfare Board to pay workers for heatwave days, as it already does for smog days, before the High Court hearing on 18 November (action 2).
- Ask the Delhi Jal Board, on 1916 or WhatsApp 9650291021, to name the tanker and standpipe points for Chirag Dilli in its 2027 summer plan, and log every missed or paid-for tanker (action 8).
- Ask the Delhi Health Department whether Madan Mohan Malaviya Hospital's heatwave ward will have ice-water immersion and an agreed transfer to Safdarjung or AIIMS by 15 March (action 4).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Get everyone sleeping rough around the dargah, the Outer Ring Road, and Sheikh Sarai into a shelter every cold night, 15 November to 15 March

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
DUSIB, with SPYM or the Centre for Holistic Development doing the outreach	15 Nov 2026 – 15 Mar 2027	Beds already funded by DUSIB; ₹1.75 lakh (US$1,840) for blankets and night escorts for people who stay outside	Deaths from exposure among people sleeping outdoors

The Centre for Holistic Development counted 474 unidentified bodies, about 80% of them homeless people, in 56 days of the 2024–25 winter, and the National Human Rights Commission took notice. These are counts of bodies, not certified causes of death. DUSIB's winter plan adds about 235–250 tents and runs 15–16 night rescue teams; the control room is 14461. Blankets go only to people outside shelters, because DUSIB already equips its shelters and tents.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No evaluation was found showing that outreach of this kind reduces winter deaths; it is a plausible measure, not a proven one. No shelter site in Chirag Dilli or Sheikh Sarai could be confirmed for 2026, so callers should use 14461 rather than a named site.

2. Pay registered construction workers for heatwave days, as Delhi already pays them for smog days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers Welfare Board, with the Labour Department	Put it in the action plan due at the High Court on 18 Nov 2026; in force by 31 Mar 2027	Estimate: ₹22.7–87.6 crore (US$2.4–9.2 million) for 5 heatwave days, paid from about ₹3,000 crore of unused cess	Workers labouring through red-alert heat because a lost day means lost wages

Trigger: an IMD heatwave warning for Delhi, matched to the Heat Action Plan's 1–4 pm halt on outdoor work. The board paid ₹8,000 (2024–25) and ₹10,000 (December 2025) to registered workers during smog construction bans; the 2024–25 payment reached 93,272 workers. The cost range is our arithmetic: ₹8,000 or ₹10,000 over 16 days, times 5 days, times 90,759 workers at the low end or the board's 2,80,249 registered workers at the high end. On 6 October 2026 the Delhi High Court found about ₹3,000 crore of cess unused and ordered an action plan.

No Indian state pays heat-day wage compensation yet, so this has no precedent and no evidence of effect on deaths. It covers registered construction workers only; vendors, domestic workers, and the momo makers of Chirag Dilli would not benefit.

3. Count every heat death daily, including bodies found outdoors, and publish the count by district from the first orange alert

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Delhi Health Department, with Delhi Police and DDMA	Daily from 1 Mar 2027	None beyond existing staff	Learning the size of a heatwave a week after it has peaked

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

India's national heat surveillance (NCDC, under NPCCHH) already requires daily reporting of suspected and confirmed heatstroke cases and deaths on the IHIP portal from 1 March. The gap is compliance and deaths outside hospitals: in June 2024 Delhi learned its homeless toll from an NGO, and an audit reported zero Delhi heat deaths for March–July 2026. Adding police records of unidentified bodies closes that gap.

This is a reporting fix, not a treatment. Its value is that it lets every other action be aimed while the heatwave is still under way.

4. Give Madan Mohan Malaviya Hospital's heatwave ward ice-water immersion and an agreed transfer to an ICU by 15 March

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Delhi Health Department	15 Mar 2027	No published figure; unfunded within the hospital budget	Deaths from heatstroke that is treated too late

Delhi's 2025 Heat Action Plan already requires heatwave wards in all government hospitals, with ice packs, ORS, and IV fluids, but not immersion. RML Hospital's unit, opened in May 2024, used two immersion tubs and an ice machine. Malaviya Hospital is South Delhi's district hospital but has no ICU and referred 890 patients out in April–November 2025, so the ward needs a written transfer route to Safdarjung or AIIMS.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Rapid whole-body cooling is the standard treatment for heatstroke. The figures for how much it lowers mortality in Delhi are clinicians' statements in the press, not a study.

5. List the tenants most at risk in Chirag Dilli's rented rooms by March, and check on them daily from the first orange alert

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
DDMA South, with Aapda Mitra and community volunteers	Map in Nov 2026; list by 1 Mar 2027; checks from April	Volunteer time; unfunded	Deaths in top-floor rooms that nobody knows are occupied

The village's havelis are split into small rented rooms, some 10×8 ft, many housing migrant families from Sikkim, Darjeeling, and Nepal who make momos from before dawn, with steamers running inside. Visit in the afternoon after production stops. List rooms that combine a top floor, a steamer, no cooler, and an older or very young occupant, with one phone number each, and reach people through the migrant and momo networks they already use. Every list held by landlords is a list of landlords.

Registers and daily checks are part of Ahmedabad's Heat Action Plan, which is credited with about 1,190 avoided deaths a year (95% CI 162–2,218), but no study has measured the register on its own. France's voluntary registers miss many of the most vulnerable.

6. Run ration-card application camps in Chirag Dilli and Sheikh Sarai while 7.7 lakh places are open

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Delhi Food and Supplies Department	Nov 2026 – Jan 2027	No published figure; the grain itself is centrally funded	Low-income workers buying staples at market price through the spring price peak

Delhi's NFSA ceiling is 72,77,995 people. A May 2026 audit removed about 7.7 lakh names, and online applications reopened on 15 May for the first time in 13 years. Migrant tenants are the households most likely to be outside the system. Grain is not short — the central pool held about 2.8 times its October norm — so the card, not supply, is the break.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No current e-KYC deadline that would cancel cards was found, so camps should not be promoted as "verify or lose your card".

7. Add Chirag Dilli to the government onion-van route now, and pre-set a tur dal release for spring

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Union Department of Consumer Affairs, through NAFED, NCCF, and Kendriya Bhandar	Onion now; tur release ready by Feb 2027	Within the existing price-stabilisation sales	Households cutting pulses and vegetables when prices spike

The onion trigger has already fired: September CPI showed onion up 108% on a year, and the Centre is selling onion at ₹35/kg from vans in Delhi. Onion should ease as the late-kharif crop arrives in November–January. Pulses are the spring risk: the monsoon was 87% of normal nationally, and the RBI's 7 October policy warned that El Niño may hit the rabi crop. Trigger for tur: the Department of Consumer Affairs' daily Delhi retail price above ₹145/kg.

Delhi's own monsoon was 16% above normal, but local rain does not set food prices; the shortfall in the growing states does. El Niño is one cause among several: hail and export policy also moved onion prices.

8. Name Chirag Dilli's tanker and standpipe points in the Delhi Jal Board's 2027 summer plan, and keep a tanker log from April

CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Delhi Jal Board, with a residents' group keeping the log	Points named by 31 Mar 2027; log from 1 Apr	Within the board's summer action plan	Households going without water in a heatwave because they cannot pay a tanker crew

A May 2025 report quoted a Chirag Dilli resident saying tanker crews ask ₹300–500 and skip households that do not pay. The board's 2026 summer plan lists complaint lines (1916, 1800117118, WhatsApp 9650291021) and a Malviya Nagar line (8427312731) but no standpipe list for the South zone. In June 2024 Haryana cut the Munak canal flow and a July breach shut a treatment plant, so the summer

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

supply depends on another state.

The bribery claim rests on one resident's account. A group log, filed together, removes the risk to any single family.

9. Paint the roofs of 200 top-floor rooms that house older people with reflective paint, February–March 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Mahila Housing Trust, with the tenant list from action 5	31 Mar 2027	₹4 lakh (US$4,200): 200 roofs × 80 sq ft × ₹25/sq ft	Some of the indoor heat in the hottest rooms

Four lenses backed cool roofs, but they all leaned on the same programme figures. Delhi's own randomised trial of reflective paint, led by EPIC India, found about 1 °C of cooling; Mahila Housing Trust's 5–6 °C figure is for modular roofs, not paint. No study links cool roofs to fewer deaths in India. That is why this is ranked last and capped at 200 rooms chosen from the tenant list.

Delhi's Cool Roof Policy 2026 is proposed but not funded for urban villages; its pilots are on public buildings. Check again in February to avoid duplicating a new scheme.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	DUSIB	Outreach NGOs (SPYM, CHD)	BOCW Welfare Board	Delhi Health Dept	Delhi Police	DDMA South	Community volunteers	Food & Supplies Dept	Consumer Affairs (NAFED, NCCF)	Delhi Jal Board	Mahila Housing Trust
1. Winter shelter outreach	**A**	**R**			**C**	**I**	**R**				
2. Heat-day wage pay			**A/R**			**C**					
3. Daily death count		**C**		**A/R**	**R**	**I**					
4. Hospital cooling bay				**A/R**		**I**					
5. Tenant heat list				**C**		**A**	**R**				**C**
6. Ration-card camps							**C**	**A/R**			
7. Onion and tur sales							**I**		**A/R**		
8. Tanker points and log						**I**	**R**			**A/R**	
9. Reflective roofs							**C**				**A/R**

What the chart shows: community volunteers carry the most rows (six) without being accountable for any, and the Delhi Health Department is accountable for two. Actions 2, 3, and 8 need a decision rather than new money: the cess, the reporting system, and the tanker plan already exist.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

₹1.75 lakh (US$1,840)

TARGET

₹5.75 lakh (US$6,040)

CEILING

₹25.5 lakh (US$26,770)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Nobody has counted the rough sleepers, tenants, or older people in Chirag Dilli

Floor: 500 blankets and escorts × ₹350 = ₹1.75 lakh. Target: the floor plus 200 reflective roofs × ₹2,000 (80 sq ft × ₹25) = ₹4 lakh, so ₹5.75 lakh. Ceiling: 1,000 blankets (₹3.5 lakh) + a HelpAge India unit if one is confirmed on this route (₹2 lakh cap) + 1,000 roofs (₹20 lakh) = ₹25.5 lakh. Above that, money starts paying for beds DUSIB already funds. The panel's target was ₹7.75 lakh; verification cut it by 26%. The 500 and the 1,000 are planning assumptions, so a street count in the first week of November sets every figure. The public money in action 2 (₹22.7–87.6 crore) sits outside this envelope.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
SPYM (runs DUSIB shelters and rescue vans) or the Centre for Holistic Development	Action 1: blankets and night escorts for people sleeping outside shelters	₹1.75 lakh (US$1,840)	Direct grant, released 15 Nov	₹300 a blanket plus distribution, about ₹333–350 each (Sewa International, 2023 price)	Partially confirmed
Mahila Housing Trust	Action 9: reflective paint on 200 top-floor rooms housing older people	₹4 lakh (US$4,200)	Direct grant	₹25–30/sq ft (MHT programme document); 80 sq ft per room; about 1 °C cooling in the Delhi trial	Partially confirmed
HelpAge India (HQ, Qutab Institutional Area)	Visits to older people living alone, Dec–Feb	Cap ₹2 lakh (US$2,100), ceiling only	Direct grant	No unit cost published; no unit confirmed on a South Delhi route	Unverified

The funder's one thing: the bed is already paid for; the walk to it is not. In this window the cheapest life saved is a person taken to a DUSIB tent on a January night, not a roof painted in October.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Sending people to a cooling centre or night shelter that nobody has checked

CONTRAINDICATED

A 2026 field audit of Delhi's Heat Action Plan found three of seven cooling centres closed at 6, 7, and 8 pm, and no public list of centres. A survey of 24 night shelters in April 2026 found about half the fans and coolers not working, and many shelters are tin-roofed cabins. A person sent to a closed centre or a hot shelter has lost the time they needed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: have the ward publish every site with its hours by March, test each one in person before April, and keep at least one open overnight.

Telling older people that a fan is enough in extreme heat*

CONTRAINDICATED

A 2021 study in *Lancet Planetary Health* (Morris et al.) found that above about 38 °C a fan adds to heat stress for healthy people over 65, and above 37 °C for people on anticholinergic medicines. It named northern India as a place where fans would regularly have made heat stress worse. Delhi passes those temperatures most days of a heatwave.

Instead: wet the skin and clothing while using the fan, and move older people to the coolest available place.

Paying for smog towers or anti-smog guns

CONTRAINDICATED

The Delhi Pollution Control Committee told the National Green Tribunal in November 2023 that the Connaught Place smog tower cleaned the air for about 200 m, not the planned 1 km, at ₹15–20 lakh a month to run. In the December 2017 Anand Vihar trial of an anti-smog gun, PM2.5 did not fall while it sprayed.

Instead: spend on dust control at source (paving, mechanical sweeping) and N95 masks for people who work outdoors.

Planning on tankers arriving on time in June

CONTRAINDICATED

In June 2024 Delhi's power demand hit a record and its water supply fell short at the same time: Haryana cut the Munak canal flow, the Supreme Court intervened over tanker leakage, and a July breach shut a treatment plant. In Chirag Dilli, residents report tanker crews skipping households that do not pay.

Instead: add household storage and a lane contact list by May, and keep the group tanker log in action 8.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE

THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
May 1998	New Delhi reaches 48.4 °C, the summer after the 1997–98 El Niño	No Delhi death count found	Nothing found
Oct 2015	Dengue outbreak in an El Niño year: 10,683 cases by 10 October, past the 1996 record	The 1996 outbreak killed 423; 2015 toll not verified	Seasonal anti-mosquito drives
Nov 2016	Worst smog in 17 years; schools closed	Not counted	GRAP, the graded smog emergency plan, notified 12 January 2017
May–Jun 2024	Heatwave the summer after the 2023–24 El Niño; 49.0–49.1 °C recorded (the 52.9 °C Mungeshpur reading was a sensor error)	192 homeless deaths counted by an NGO, 11–19 June, causes awaiting post-mortem; about 20 heatstroke deaths at RML Hospital	Heat Action Plan 2025 required heatwave wards in government hospitals
Jun–Jul 2024	Water crisis: Haryana cut Munak canal flow; Supreme Court intervened; canal breach shut a treatment plant	Not counted	Annual Delhi Jal Board summer action plans
Nov 2024 – Jan 2025	Severe smog (AQI 494, Stage 4 curbs on 18 November) and winter cold	474 unidentified bodies in 56 days, about 80% taken to be homeless (NGO count)	National Human Rights Commission took notice
2026	El Niño monsoon: 87% of normal nationally, 16% above normal at Safdarjung; onion up 108% in September	—	Government onion sales at ₹35/kg; RBI raised rates on 7 October, citing El Niño

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Delhi's worst heat has come in the summer after an El Niño winter, not during it — 1998, 2010, and 2024. That is three cases, not a tested pattern, but it points straight at April–June 2027, just after the forecast window closes. Each time, the plan came after the disaster: GRAP after 2016, heatwave wards after 2024, and only pilot cool roofs by 2026.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **"The 300 deaths forecast for October–March are mostly cold and smog"** versus **"the figure counts heat only"**. Four lenses read the winter forecast as cold deaths. The data says otherwise: Russia and Finland show exactly zero in every winter month, which could not happen if cold deaths were counted. So the 300 are deaths from warmer-than-normal days, including in winter, and Delhi's documented winter deaths from cold are a separate hazard carried here by the historical record. The panel's priority on winter shelter stands; its reading of the number does not.
- **Enrol women in Mahila Housing Trust's heat insurance** (Economist) versus **do not fund it** (Philanthropist). It is real: about 8,500 women in Delhi and Faridabad, paying ₹100–500 when the temperature passes 45.27–47 °C, capped at ₹2,000 a season. But the 2026 payouts averaged about ₹52 per woman, the weather station that triggers it is not named, and 2027 enrolment is unconfirmed. It is not recommended here until those three things are known.
- **Cool roofs save lives** (four lenses) versus **Delhi's own trial found about 1 °C**. The agreement came from shared programme figures, not independent evidence, which is why action 9 is ranked last.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens could find a count of anyone in Chirag Dilli: rough sleepers, tenants, older people living alone, or which languages they speak (Nepali and Hindi are likely, given where tenants come from, but unconfirmed). Every quantity in this briefing that depends on Chirag Dilli itself is a planning assumption. A door-to-door count in November, the first step of action 5, would change the funding envelope, the size of action 9, and possibly the order of the list. No lens covered heat inside the momo kitchens themselves, where steamers run in small rooms through the hottest months.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

The Climate Impact Lab figure here is published for NCT of Delhi, about 20 million people, not for Chirag Dilli; it is not a neighbourhood figure. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; cold, smog, water shortage, dengue, and food prices are additional to it and are carried here by the

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Chirag Dilli, the urban village around the dargah of Hazrat Nasiruddin Mahmud Roshan Chirag-e-Dilli, MCD Ward 172 (South Zone, inferred), Malviya Nagar sub-division, Greater Kailash assembly constituency. Climate Impact Lab figures were available only for NCT of Delhi (state level); no impact region was resolved. Sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): NCT of Delhi, 43 additional heat deaths June–September 2026 (net), 300 forecast October 2026 – March 2027, 340 in total; India, 160,000. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*, whose global total is now 857,400 for June 2026 – March 2027. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Five verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. Food actions were checked for live price series and timing. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted. Its "Download Inventory" link leads to a registration form, and the browse page loads its data in the browser and returned no entries when fetched. No action here should be read as having no precedent; none was checked.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in Indian rupees with US dollars in parentheses, at ₹95.25 = US$1 (FBIL reference rate published by the Reserve Bank of India, 30 October 2026). 1 lakh = 100,000; 1 crore = 10 million.
- **Reader.** This briefing was built at El Niño Ready's initiative, not from a request. No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. The "For you" steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about residents here; any step not drawn from a ranked action was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the city and its partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (cooling older people, fan warnings, and heatstroke treatment) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Several Delhi figures come from press reports of NGO counts that officials dispute. The 2026–27 DUSIB winter plan had not been published. Whether the Chirag Dilli Mohalla Clinic is still open, or now an Ayushman Arogya Mandir, could not be confirmed. The locator map shows Delhi at country scale; the village itself is not drawn.

References · status after verification

Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); tracker · confirmed

DoT, short code 14461 for the night-shelter control room: dot.gov.in/node/18753 · confirmed

DUSIB winter action plan: Millennium Post · corrected (2024–25 plan)

NHRC on 474 homeless deaths: nhrc.nic.in; CHD letter: IDR · confirmed as NGO count

192 homeless deaths, June 2024: Business Today · confirmed as NGO count

Delhi HC on ₹3,000 crore cess: LiveLaw · confirmed; GRAP payouts: Millennium Post, News on Air; registered workers: The Patriot · corrected

Heatwave notified disaster: Mongabay India; UT Disaster Response Fund: Union Budget, Demand 57 · confirmed

MHT heat insurance: Down To Earth; Reinsurance Asia · corrected

Ayushman and Vay Vandana in Delhi: Medical Dialogues; Tribune · corrected

NCDC heat surveillance FAQ: ncdc.mohfw.gov.in · confirmed; Heat Action Plan audits: The Leaflet I, II · confirmed

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RML heatstroke unit: Medical Dialogues; HAP 2025 hospital wards: Millennium Post; Malaviya Hospital referrals: Medical Dialogues · confirmed

Ahmedabad Heat Action Plan evaluation (Hess et al. 2018): PMC6236972 · confirmed (before-after design)

Chirag Dilli tenants and momo makers: The Migration Story, 16 Aug 2024 · corrected

Ration cards: Open; India TV · corrected; Atal Canteens: Goodreturns, ThePrint · corrected

CPI September 2026: MoSPI · confirmed; onion at ₹35/kg: Telangana Today · confirmed; monsoon: IMD all-India, IMD New Delhi · confirmed; DCA retail prices: fcainfoweb.nic.in · confirmed (daily)

Water: The Patriot, May 2025; DJB Summer Action Plan 2026 · confirmed

Cool roofs: Citizen Matters; EPIC; MHT; Delhi HAP 2026 · corrected

Do-not sources: Down To Earth, smog tower; Business Standard, anti-smog gun; Morris et al. 2021; ThePrint, shelters · confirmed

Record: News on Air, Mungeshpur; India TV, dengue 2015; Phys.org, 2016 smog; Moneylife, 2024 water · as cited by the panel

Ward and sub-division: Delhi Revenue Department gazette list · confirmed

Generated 30 October 2026 for Chirag Dilli, Delhi. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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